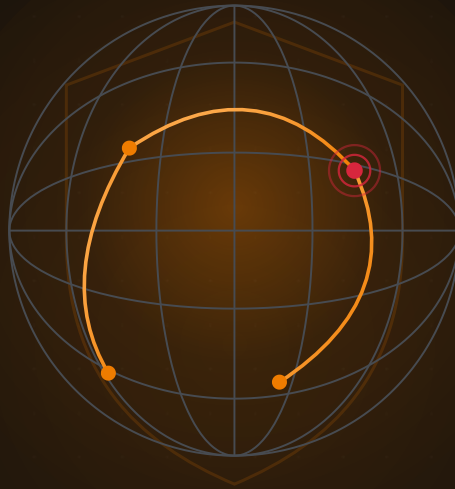




THREAT PULSE

WEEKLY CYBER THREAT BRIEFING

WEEK IN REVIEW · 7–13 SEPTEMBER 2026

Inside this week: Microsoft's **largest-ever monthly security update** fixes two Windows flaws already under attack and a **wormable server flaw** that needs no password, a **“perfect-10” flaw in Cisco firewall management** is being exploited to seize control, and the fintech **Revolut handed customer data to fraudsters** posing as a government agency — explained in plain English, with the practical steps that matter.

Welcome to **Threat Pulse**, your plain-English weekly round-up of the cyber threats making waves around the world — and what they mean for your business. This week Microsoft shipped its **biggest-ever monthly update**, fixing a record number of flaws — including two Windows weaknesses **already being exploited** and a **wormable server flaw** that needs no password; a maximum-severity **Cisco firewall** flaw is being used to seize control of security appliances; and the fintech **Revolut** was tricked into handing customer data to fraudsters posing as a government agency. No jargon, just what happened and the practical steps worth taking.

AT A GLANCE THIS WEEK

 **966**

Security flaws Microsoft fixed in a single month this September — the most it has ever patched at once

 **2**

Windows zero-day flaws already being used in real attacks when September's fixes arrived

 **9.8** /10

Severity of a wormable Windows DNS Server flaw needing no password and no clicks — patch before it's weaponised

THIS WEEK'S HEADLINE THREAT

MICROSOFT SEPTEMBER 2026 PATCH TUESDAY • 2 EXPLOITED ZERO-DAYS + WORMABLE DNS FLAW CVE-2026-69730

Microsoft's biggest-ever monthly patch fixes two flaws already under attack — and a wormable one waiting to happen

9.8
/10 CVSS

CRITICAL

Exploitation: **two flaws already active; wormable one not yet**

WHAT'S HAPPENING

Microsoft's September security update is its **largest ever** — a record run of flaws fixed in one month. Two (**CVE-2026-81963** and **CVE-2026-85880**) were **already being used in real attacks** to take full control of a Windows machine an attacker had a foot inside. Worse, it also fixes **CVE-2026-69730**, a **Windows DNS Server** flaw (the service that turns website names into addresses) rated **9.8/10** that a remote attacker could use to run code with **no password and no clicks** — and which could spread from server to server on its own ("wormable"). It isn't being exploited yet; the fix landed first.

WHO'S AFFECTED

Essentially **every business running Windows**. The two already-exploited flaws affect everyday Windows 10, 11 and Windows Server PCs. The wormable DNS flaw affects organisations that run the **Windows DNS Server role in-house** — typically on-premises Windows Servers and domain controllers.

WHY IT MATTERS TO YOU

The two exploited flaws are how attackers turn a small break-in into **full control of a computer**, so they matter to anyone who could be phished or open a bad file. The DNS flaw matters because it needs **no password and can spread by itself** — exactly the recipe behind past internet-wide outbreaks — so patching it before someone weaponises it is the whole game.

Good news if your servers are cloud-hosted and fully managed, or you don't run the Windows DNS Server role yourself: the wormable flaw is likely not yours to fix. The two exploited Windows flaws still apply to everyday PCs, so keeping Windows Update current remains the single most valuable habit — worth confirming with your IT provider.

What to do about the headline threat

-  Install **this month's Windows and Windows Server updates everywhere** — priority to servers running the **DNS role** (this closes the wormable CVE-2026-69730) and to any PC that could be phished.
-  **Turn on automatic updates** if they aren't already, so future emergency fixes land without waiting on someone to remember.
-  Ask your IT provider to **confirm every server — especially domain controllers and DNS servers** — has September's update, since those are the machines the wormable flaw targets.

OTHER THREATS WORTH KNOWING ABOUT



HIGH

A “perfect-10” flaw in Cisco firewall management is being used to seize root control

CISA has ordered US federal agencies to patch **CVE-2026-20079** — rated the **maximum 10 out of 10** — in **Cisco Secure Firewall Management Center** by 12 September after confirming attackers are actively exploiting it. The flaw lets an attacker **bypass the login and take full “root” control** of the appliance that manages an organisation’s firewalls, with no password needed; investigators have already found web shells and malware planted through it.

Takeaway: if you or your IT provider run Cisco Secure Firewall Management Center, confirm it’s patched to the fixed version now and check it for signs of tampering.



HIGH

Fortinet firewall flaw weaponised to plant remote-control malware on thousands of devices

A flaw in Fortinet’s **FortiOS, FortiSwitchManager and FortiSASE (CVE-2025-25249)** is being actively exploited in a campaign that installs a remote-access trojan called **“PivotC2”**. Researchers counted over **3,000 devices targeted** and at least **178 infected**, with the earliest activity traced to July. CISA added it to its must-patch list with the same **12 September** deadline as the Cisco flaw above.

Takeaway: confirm any Fortinet devices are on the latest firmware and, if you can’t patch straight away, take the management interface off the public internet.



MEDIUM

Revolut handed customer data to fraudsters posing as a government agency

The fintech **Revolut** confirmed on **12 September** that scammers using fake “emergency” law-enforcement and government data requests — sent from a convincing government email address — tricked it into handing over sensitive customer information, including **copies of ID documents and transaction histories**. No systems were “hacked”: the weak point was a person acting on a request that looked official.

Takeaway: the strongest technical defences don’t help if a convincing request gets a “yes” — verify any request for sensitive data or payments through a separate, known channel before anyone acts.



Your 3-minute checklist this week

- ✓ Install **September’s Windows and Windows Server updates** everywhere — prioritise servers running the **DNS role** (see previous page).
- ✓ If you use **Cisco Secure Firewall Management Center**, confirm CVE-2026-20079 is patched and check it for tampering.
- ✓ If you use **Fortinet** (FortiOS / FortiSwitchManager / FortiSASE), confirm the latest firmware is installed.
- ✓ Remind staff to **verify any “official” request for data or payment** through a separate, known channel before acting.

Threat Pulse is provided by DPG-Cyber for general awareness only and does not constitute specific security or legal advice. Threat details are drawn from reputable public reporting as at 14 September 2026 and may evolve as investigations continue. For guidance tailored to your environment, please contact your DPG-Cyber account team.

BEHIND THE HEADLINES

Why a **watchful eye** changes the outcome

Every threat in this issue had one thing in common: the damage happened in the **quiet gap between the break-in and the moment someone noticed**. Tools alone rarely stop an attack — what limits the harm is continuous monitoring that correlates the signals, spots the intrusion early, and responds before a foothold becomes a crisis.

247 days

Average time for organisations to identify *and* contain a breach

SOURCE: IBM COST OF A DATA BREACH 2026

\$4.99M

Global average total cost of a single data breach

SOURCE: IBM COST OF A DATA BREACH 2026

THE WINDOW THAT MATTERS

Intrusion
the way in

Foothold
quietly settling in

Lateral movement
spreading across systems

Impact
data theft / ransomware

↑ The sooner an attack is spotted, the smaller the damage. Closing this window — detecting and responding on the left, long before impact on the right — is the entire job of a Security Operations Centre.

WHAT CONTINUOUS MONITORING QUIETLY DOES



Sees across everything

A SIEM gathers and correlates activity from across your systems, so unusual behaviour stands out instead of hiding in the noise.



Watches around the clock

Attacks don't keep office hours. A SOC means real people monitoring day, night and weekends — not just 9 to 5.



Knows the latest tactics

Fresh threat intelligence — like the appliance flaws and impersonation scam in this issue — feeds detection so new tricks are recognised fast.



Acts, not just alerts

Alerts are triaged and investigated by analysts who step in early, turning a would-be incident into a non-event.

CLIENT ACTION OF THE WEEK

THIS WEEK'S FIX

Install this month's Windows updates

September's Microsoft update is the **largest ever** and closes two flaws attackers are already using, plus a wormable server flaw. Roll it out across every Windows PC and server this week — servers running the **DNS role** first.

GOOD HABIT

Run a quick phishing-awareness drill

A short, no-blame test email helps your team spot the fake "urgent" messages and impersonation tricks behind so many breaches — and shows where a little training would help most.

This is the quiet, everyday work behind **DPG-Cyber's SIEM & SOC services** — the same monitoring and response that turns headlines like these into non-events for the businesses we look after. If you're ever curious how it would map to your own environment, we're always happy to talk it through, no pressure — just drop us a line at hello@dpg-cyber.com.